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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Gov. Pritzker signs off on Illinois budget

Transit issue remains unaddressed amid federal funding uncertainty, likely cuts

By **Olivia Olander, Jeremy Gornor and A.D. Quig**
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker on Monday signed his seventh state budget, balanced as he promised with cuts, taxes and one-time revenue boosts

but leaving for future months the battle over one major spending issue, an expected \$771 million shortfall for Chicago-area transit systems. Legislators adjourned their spring session without passing a transit plan, and Pritzker on

Monday did his best to deflect responsibility for the problem, saying transit is “not a state budget issue... It’s really a separate matter entirely.” “The answer is not that the state is solely responsible for filling that gap. There are lots of sources,” Pritzker said, ticking off Cook County, the collar counties, the city of Chicago, riders and changes within the systems as players in solving the problem. “Everybody’s

focusing only on the state when actually there’s a whole lot to put together here.” While it’s true that transit funding has been negotiated separately from the state’s operating budget throughout the year, state lawmakers have the ability to implement tax increases as possible funding solutions. Proposals to increase fees on ride-shares and deliveries failed to make it out of the General Assembly. State legislation would

also be needed to reorganize the transit systems now under the Regional Transportation Agency. The transit issue remains unaddressed at a time when federal funding remains uncertain as Republicans in Washington negotiate major budget cuts. Democratic state Rep. Kam Buckner of Chicago, a lead budget negotiator in the House who has

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Maps show where city ordinance could help

Advisory council would inform future environmental policy

By **Adriana Pérez**
Chicago Tribune

As communities are urging their representatives to support an environmental ordinance introduced in April to the City Council, a neighborhood group released maps showing large swaths of land across the city are currently zoned for commercial warehouses and industrial manufacturing that don’t require public notice or city approval to be developed.

Wards with the most land where this kind of use is permitted include the 10th Ward on the city’s Southeast Side, the 11th and 12th Wards on the South Side, the 25th Ward on the Lower West Side, and the 27th Ward on the Northwest Side.

“I was born and raised in the community, in Brighton Park, and we have a lot of manufacturing around our ward — and it was designed that way,” said Ald. Julia Ramirez, 12th. “The Hazel Johnson ordinance also considers the compounded impact that the community has already gone through.”

Named after the so-called mother of the environmental justice movement started over 40 years ago in Chicago, the ordinance would establish an advisory council to inform future environmental policy. Its main goal, however, would be to change zoning practices by requiring developers to study the possible cumulative impacts of a new project or an expansion, such as how it would affect public health in a community given already existing polluters, and meet with neighbors before applying for city approval.

It’s a tool, Ramirez said, to involve the community in decisions that will affect them.

“That’s the part that’s actually been missing from a lot of the

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Smoke rises after a reported Israeli strike on a building used by the Islamic Republic of Iran News Network, part of Iran’s state TV broadcaster, on Monday in Tehran, Iran. **GETTY**

Israel strikes state-run Iranian television station

Trump warning in post calls for all of Tehran to evacuate

By **Ami Bentov and Melanie Lidman**
Associated Press

TEL AVIV, Israel — Israel struck Iran’s state-run television station Monday during a live broadcast, forcing a reporter to run off camera following an explosion, after Iran fired a new wave of missiles at Israel that killed at least eight people.

President Donald Trump was departing the Group of Seven summit in Canada on Monday night a day early due to the

conflict between Israel and Iran. In other developments, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the Israeli strikes have set Iran’s nuclear program back a “very, very long time.” He added that Israel is not attempting to topple the Iranian government, but he said he would not be surprised if that happened as a result of the strikes.

“The regime is very weak,” Netanyahu told a news conference. He also said he is in daily

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Israeli rescue workers and security personnel inspect and clear the buildings and area hit by an Iranian rocket on Monday in central Tel Aviv, Israel. **ALEXI J. ROSENFELD/GETTY**



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Juneteenth flags raised

Olawale Idreez, center, waves two flags Monday during a Juneteenth flag-raising ceremony at Daley Plaza in Chicago. June 19 marks the arrival of Union soldiers in Galveston, Texas, announcing the freedom of enslaved African Americans more than two years after the Emancipation Proclamation.

A year after encampments swept universities, three pro-Palestinian protesters speak out

By **Ikram Mohamed**
Chicago Tribune

Six months have passed since fourth-year University of Chicago student Mamayan Jabateh last stepped foot on campus.

Jabateh was one of two students arrested after she participated in an October demonstration calling for an end to the university’s investment in weapons manufacturers arming Israel.

The protest, which drew a crowd of more than 150 people, was initially peaceful, Jabateh said. Students and staff stood before the crowd giving speeches, later moving through the campus. When campus police intervened, that all changed.

Last spring, university students, including Jabateh at the U. of C. and others across the country erected 130 encampments on the lawns of their campuses, barricading themselves from law enforcement to stand in solidarity with Palestinians in Gaza, where bombardments have destroyed nearly all higher education institutions. Since the October 2023 Hamas attack, which left 1,200 Israelis dead and more than 250 hostages, the ensuing war has killed 55,000 Palestinians according to the Gaza Health Ministry. Several Chicago-area universities, including Northwestern, the University of Chicago and Loyola, made national and international news for their encampments.

Many students dove into the protests, understanding the consequences they’d face — possible suspension, expulsion, and, for some, their diplomas withheld. Yet, they continued, they said, passionate about the cause they were fighting for. More than a year later, the repercussions continue as well, as the Trump administration aims to punish the students who participated, signaling a wider, more coordinated federal crackdown on pro-Palestinian protesters on college campuses. As universities continue to discipline student activists and attempt to quell on-campus demonstrations, the pro-Palestinian movement has become

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